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Overview

Purpose	This document describes how to conduct a complaint investigation.
Scope	This document applies to functions that are responsible for complaint investigation.
Roles	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit (FDCHU) Operating Unit (OU) Complaint Unit

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Terms and Definitions

Term	Definition	Source
Cause	The fundamental or primary reason that the alleged event occurred that is supported by all Reasonably Known Information.	Medtronic
Complaint Investigation	Assessment activities, including technical assessments, product analysis or review of information to evaluate and identify, if applicable, the cause and/or contributing factors of an individual event and determine if further investigation should be recommended.	Medtronic
Contributing Factor	Elements that helped an outcome or event occur but may not be the sole reason for the outcome.	Medtronic
Cybersecurity Signal	Any information that indicates the potential for, or confirmation of, a cybersecurity vulnerability or exploit that affects or could affect a medical device.	Medtronic
Device Issue	Any device malfunction, defect or anomaly.	Medtronic
Further Action	Escalation of the complaint issue to assess for further investigation per D00003516, <i>Manage Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA)</i> or other investigation/correction methods documented within a quality management system (ex: product change orders, SCAPAs, HRA's etc.).	Medtronic
Further Investigation Activities	Investigation activities conducted, in addition to the complaint investigation, to assess for, as applicable, risk and/or the cause of the event to determine if further actions are needed.	Medtronic
Labeled Adverse Event	An adverse event that is identified within product labeling as warning, precaution or potential adverse event and is listed within the Risk Management File.	Medtronic
Out of Box (OOB)	An immediate device issue identified upon opening or initial set up.	Medtronic

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Term	Definition	Source
	Example scenarios that are generally NOT considered OOB: • Off-label use (Device used against Instructions for Use (IFU)) • Device dropped after opening	
Product Labeling (<i>noun</i>)	Written, printed, electronic, or graphic information affixed to a medical device or its packaging system, or accompanying a medical device, related to identification, technical description and use of the medical device, but excluding shipping documents. This includes adhesive labels, printed information on packaging, device marketing, and package inserts/instructions for use (IFU).	Medtronic
Person Qualified to Make a Medical Judgement	A person who has the background needed to judge the severity of an event, device relationship to event, or the likelihood of harm if the event type were to recur. Persons qualified to make a medical judgment include physicians, nurses, risk managers, and biomedical engineers. They may be an employee of Medtronic, or an outside consultant. NOTE: If the Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit does not have a Person Qualified to Make a Medical Judgement, a Medical Safety Clinician can be consulted for medical judgement.	Medtronic
Potential Manufacturing Issue	A device issue where an aspect of the manufacturing process may have contributed to the issue (includes external supplier manufacturing process). Examples of potential manufacturing issues may include: ▪ Sterile packaging compromised ▪ Foreign material inside sterile package ▪ Missing, damaged or detached components/devices in a package ▪ Labeling issue ▪ Failure of product OOB	Medtronic

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Term	Definition	Source
	Device issue that has been previously identified as potentially related to manufacturing (may include previous Further Action or Investigation activities where the cause is potentially related to manufacturing/assembling of the device)	
Product Analysis	Assessment conducted to indicate, when possible, whether the product meets specifications or passed functional testing.	Medtronic
Secondary (Incidental) finding	A device issue that is not part of the original complaint but is discovered during the investigation (including product analysis, image review, etc.)	Medtronic
Suspected cause	Inferring a possible cause to the failure/complaint based on reasonably known information.	Medtronic
Reasonably Known	Includes information found in documents that Medtronic possesses and any information that becomes available as a result of reasonable follow-up. There is no requirement to evaluate or investigate the event by obtaining or evaluating information that is not reasonably known.	Medtronic
Technical Assessment	Specific activities performed by Functional SMEs to provide input into the complaint investigation process.	Medtronic

Process Overview



Completed Complaint Investigation Record

- See Appendix A – Complaint Investigation High Level Process Flow for additional details

Process Detail

1. Determine if Complaint Investigation is Necessary

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Determine whether a complaint investigation is required using Appendix B - <i>Investigation Determination Decision Tree</i> . Situations where a complaint investigation may not be required include: ▪ The event does not meet complaint criteria as defined by 027-WI185, <i>Intake, Assessment, and Complaint Determination</i>. ▪ Medtronic does not have investigation responsibilities. ▪ There is no allegation of possible failure of a device, labeling, or packaging to meet any of its specifications, <i>and</i> the complaint is not a reportable event per 054-P044, <i>Medical Device Reporting</i>.
2.		Document the following information in the complaint record if a complaint investigation is <i>not</i> required: • Rationale for no complaint investigation per Appendix B - <i>Investigation Determination Decision Tree</i>. ▪ Name of the individual responsible for the decision ▪ Date the decision was made

2. Perform Complaint Investigation

2.1 Review the Event

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Review event information that is necessary to perform the complaint investigation. Relevant event information may include but is not limited to: ▪ Event narrative ▪ Incoming information from the source or follow-up contacts ▪ Product analysis results ▪ Image reviews ▪ Consultation results
2.		If the event involves an adverse event(s), review the file to determine the relationship of the adverse event(s) to the device(s).

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Step	Role	Action
		If relationship is unclear, consult with a Person Qualified to Make A Medical Judgement to assess the event.

2.2 Technical Assessments

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Use Appendix C - <i>Technical Assessment Initiation Criteria</i> , to determine which, if any, technical assessment tasks are needed.
2.		Initiate the necessary technical assessment tasks. NOTE: Technical Assessment tasks will be completed by an appropriate Functional Subject Matter Expert per D00827459, <i>Investigation Technical Assessments</i>
3.		Once the technical assessment has been completed, review: - The technical assessment results - Any recommendations included in the assessment, including recommendation for further action - Any requested additional actions, such as additional follow-up
4.		After technical assessments are completed if new relevant information is received, assess whether any of the completed technical assessments need to be re-opened. Potential situations that may require re-opening a technical assessment include: - Information that was requested by the Functional SME completing the technical assessment is received - Updated event details, including new or changed adverse events, harm, or patient outcome - Updates regarding device relatedness - New clinical information such as laboratory results, images or patient medical history Re-open the technical assessment if re-evaluation is required.

2.3 Determine Cause(s) of the event

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Evaluate all available information within the complaint file, including: - Event narrative - Product analysis results

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Step	Role	Action
		- Conclusion of any technical assessments performed - Any new information received
2.		Determine if the cause can be ascertained based on Reasonably Known information. If the cause is known, document the cause and support for this determination in accordance with Section 3.
3.		If the cause cannot be determined based on Reasonably Known information, determine if there is a suspected cause or if there are known contributing factors. Document in accordance with Section 3. Suspected cause or known contributing factors may include: - Information provided in the initial report to Medtronic (e.g. a controller was dropped) - Risk management documentation
4.		If after reviewing all available information and completing follow up, the cause/suspected cause/contributing factors cannot be determined, document the rationale to support this determination in accordance with Section 3. Scenarios where cause may not be able to be determined include the following: The returned complaint product tested within specification/performed as expected. The device was not returned, or no analysis is available.

2.4 Further Action(s)

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Determine if further action is necessary; consult Functional SME(s) and the results of Technical Assessments as needed.
2.		If the complaint investigation determines that a new or unexpected post-market device or therapy issue exists that has <i>not</i> been previously predicted per the product risk management file, refer to D00003516 or OU specific escalation process for further action. - If further action escalation is needed, document the further action reference number within the complaint investigation. - NOTE: Depending on which process area is responsible for the Further Action, escalation/initiation of Further Action

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Step	Role	Action
		may be completed by someone other than the Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit representative.
3.		If no further action is needed, document the rationale. Appendix E - <i>No Further Action Flowchart</i> can be used to help determine the appropriate rationale for no further action. Rationales for no further action include: ▪ Event is not a complaint ▪ There is an existing/previous corrective action or investigation ▪ Device tested within specification /device performed as intended: – There is evidence to support that no device, packaging, quality, or design issues occurred and/or that the device functioned per specification ▪ Event foreseen in risk management and included in monitoring/trending: – The issue is a known event with a cause documented in the product risk management file, and the harm/severity of the event is less than or equal to what is listed in the risk management files. ▪ Cause not related to product: – The Medical Safety Assessment or review by a Person Qualified to Make a Medical Decision from <i>within</i> Medtronic determines that the alleged adverse event(s) were not related to the device or therapy ▪ Insufficient information: – There is inadequate information to identify a distinct failure or assess the event, and a good faith effort (GFE) has been made per 027-WI188, <i>Customer Communication</i> to obtain that information – This rationale may also be used if Medtronic does not have investigation responsibilities (ex: some OEM devices).

3. Document Complaint Investigation

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	Include the following items in the complaint file: ▪ Rationale if no DHR was performed ▪ A conclusion for each technical assessment task completed (if any). – Full details of a technical assessment may remain in the associated technical assessment task ▪ Conclusion of any analysis performed (if applicable) ▪ An explanation as to whether the device failed to meet specifications – This may be indicated via corresponding drop-down option within the investigation task if such option is available within the complaint handling system. ▪ Document the conclusion of the cause assessment performed in Section 2.3. – When documenting suspected cause(s), clearly state that the cause is suspected or most likely. – If secondary findings were noted, a cause statement must be documented. – If cause for this type of event has been previously determined, include the appropriate reference (e.g. CAPA record, HRA record, risk management file, etc.). ▪ Information regarding further action determination, including any correction or corrective action taken – See Section 2.4 <i>Further Action</i> for additional information

4. Complete Complaint Investigation

Step	Role	Action
1.	Formally Designated Complaint Handling Unit	If the complaint investigation determines that activities related to non-Medtronic manufacturing (e.g., supplier, Contract Manufacturer (CM)) contributed to the complaint: ▪ Communicate the information to the external party ▪ Document the communication in the complaint record. NOTES: ▪ Communication to the external party may be provided through Medtronic Supplier Quality.

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Step	Role	Action
2.		- Notification to the manufacturer may be accomplished via a CM/OEM Assessment Once the complaint investigation is complete and no additional analysis/information is needed, review Appendix F - <i>Investigation Completion Checklist</i> and ensure the following information is included in the file: - Name of the person who is responsible for completing the complaint investigation - Completion date and results for the complaint investigation - Applicable coding - Name of the device - Date when the complaint was received - Any unique device identifier or universal product code and any other device identification(s) and control number(s) that are used - Name, address, and phone number of the complainant/initial reporter, as permitted by privacy regulations - Nature and details of the complaint - Any correction or corrective action that was taken - Any reply to the complainant NOTE: Consider if regulatory decisions need to be reassessed per 054-P044.

References

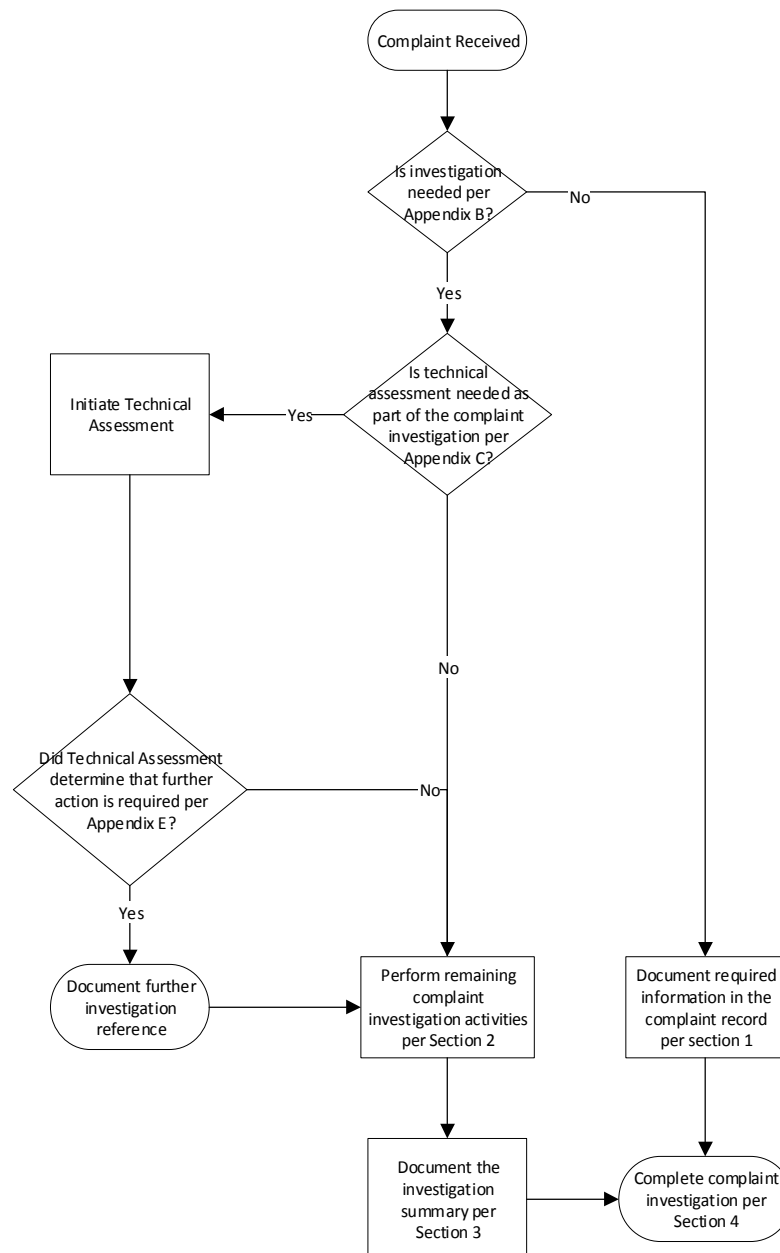
Number	Title
027-WI185	Intake, Assessment, and Complaint Determination
027-WI188	Customer Communication
D00827459	Investigation Technical Assessments
D00003516	Manage Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA)
054-P044	Medical Device Reporting

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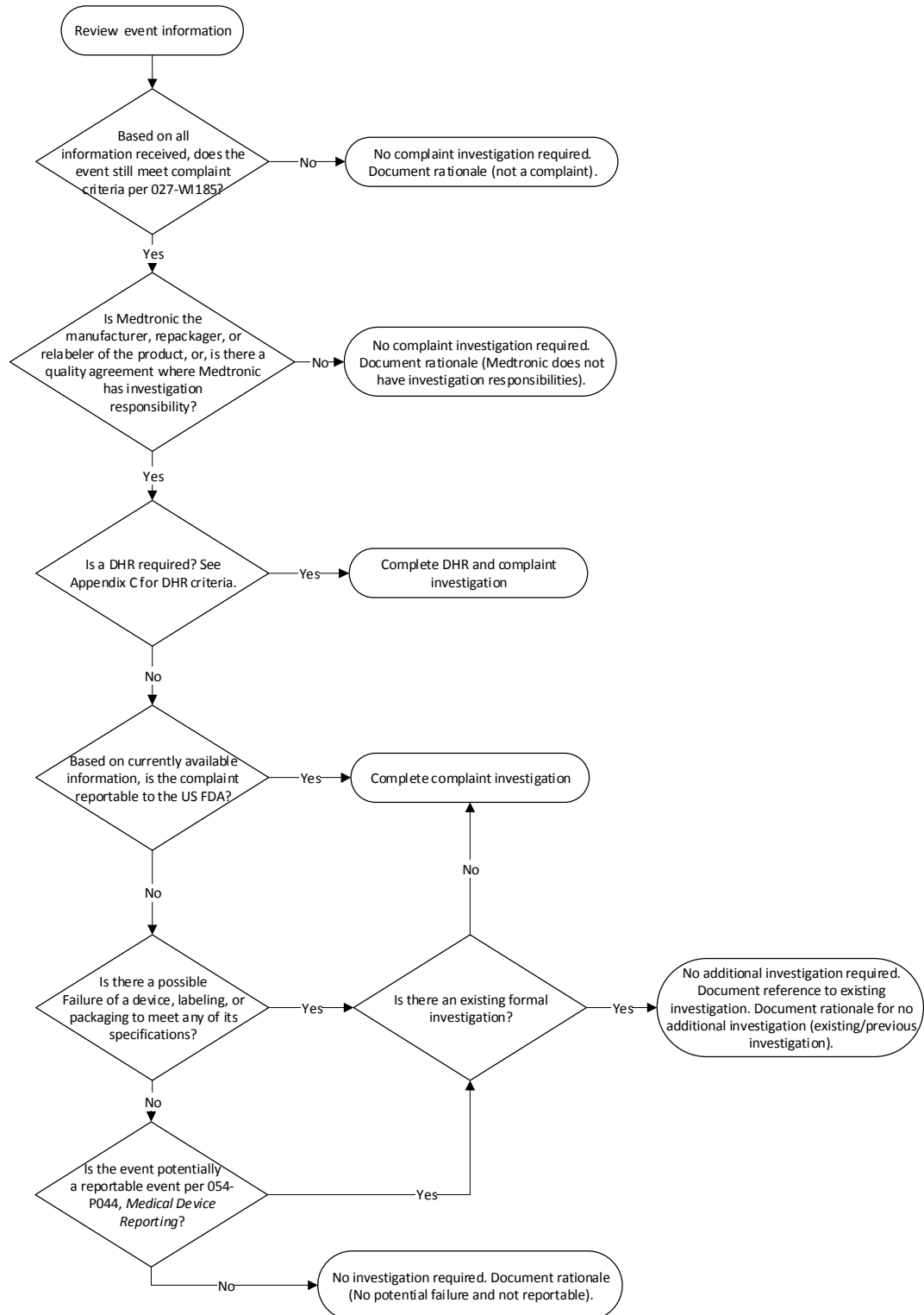
Quality Records

Quality Record	Required Approvals
Complaint Record	None

Appendix A – Complaint Investigation High Level Process Flow



Appendix B – Investigation Determination Decision Tree



Appendix C –Technical Assessment Initiation Criteria

NOTES:

- Technical assessment activities may be initiated throughout the complaint process, as needed.
- The criteria outlined in the table below indicates when each type of technical assessment task may be needed.
- Technical assessments may also be initiated for events outside of the suggested criteria below.
- Technical assessments may not be required if any of the following apply:
 - The event meets inclusion criteria for an existing further action
 - Information required to initiate technical assessment is unavailable after conducting Good Faith Effort (GFE) to obtain the information.
 - The event meets exclusion criteria provided in a local procedure

Task Type	Criteria to Initiate
Cybersecurity Assessment	Initiate a Cybersecurity Assessment if the event meets the definition of “Cybersecurity Signal” NOTES: ▪ A Cybersecurity Assessment is needed even though the alleged cybersecurity issue has not been confirmed/substantiated. ▪ Cybersecurity signals can include allegations related to Software as A Medical Device (SaMD), ex: operating systems or applications. ▪ If the complaint was provided to the Complaint Handling unit from the OU Product Security Team and the initial information included their investigation of the issue, then a Cybersecurity task is not needed unless there has been additional information received which may impact the Cybersecurity assessment.
Device History Record (DHR)	Refer to Appendix D – <i>DHR Decision Tree</i> to determine if a DHR task is required for a device where Medtronic makes the finished good. Do not use DHR tasks for Contract Manufacturer (CM)/Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) products/components; use the CM/OEM Assessment Task. NOTES: ▪ See definition for “Out of Box” and “Potential Manufacturing Issue” in the Terms and Definitions section
Manufacturing Assessment	Initiate a Manufacturing Assessment task if any of the following conditions are met for a device where Medtronic makes the finished good (do not use Manufacturing Assessment task for CM/OEM products; use the CM/OEM Assessment Task): ▪ A DHR review concluded that a Manufacturing Assessment is required

Task Type	Criteria to Initiate
	- Product analysis or other investigation activities indicate that manufacturing is a possible cause of the event. NOTES: - A manufacturing assessment is not required if the issue is in scope of an existing/previous further action or investigation activity - See definition for “Out of Box” and “Potential Manufacturing Issue” in the Terms and Definitions section.
(CM/OEM) Assessment	Initiate a CM/OEM Assessment if any of following criteria are met for an OEM device: - The event details indicate a potential manufacturing issue and/or servicing issue. Refer to Appendix D – <i>DHR Decision Tree</i> to determine if a CM/OEM assessment for a DHR task is required. - Returned product analysis indicates a manufacturing and/or servicing issue NOTES: - See definition for “Out of Box” and “Potential Manufacturing Issue” in the Terms and Definitions section
Design Assessment	Initiate a Design Assessment if any of following criteria are met: - The event suggests a possible new or unanticipated device or software issue - The device or software issue is related to an existing or previous further action but does not meet the inclusion criteria or scope (e.g., a new model displays a previously investigated failure mode), or meets criteria other than a higher than expected harm severity NOTES: - Standard software analysis alone does not mean that requirements for a Design Assessment are met. - Manufacturing can propose a Design Assessment if the DHR or Manufacturing Assessment indicates one is needed - External customer request related to the product design
Medical Safety Assessment	Initiate a Medical Safety Assessment if any of following criteria are met: - An adverse event resulting in a higher severity harm than is predicted in the risk management file - A serious injury or death occurs that is not a Labeled Adverse Event. NOTES:

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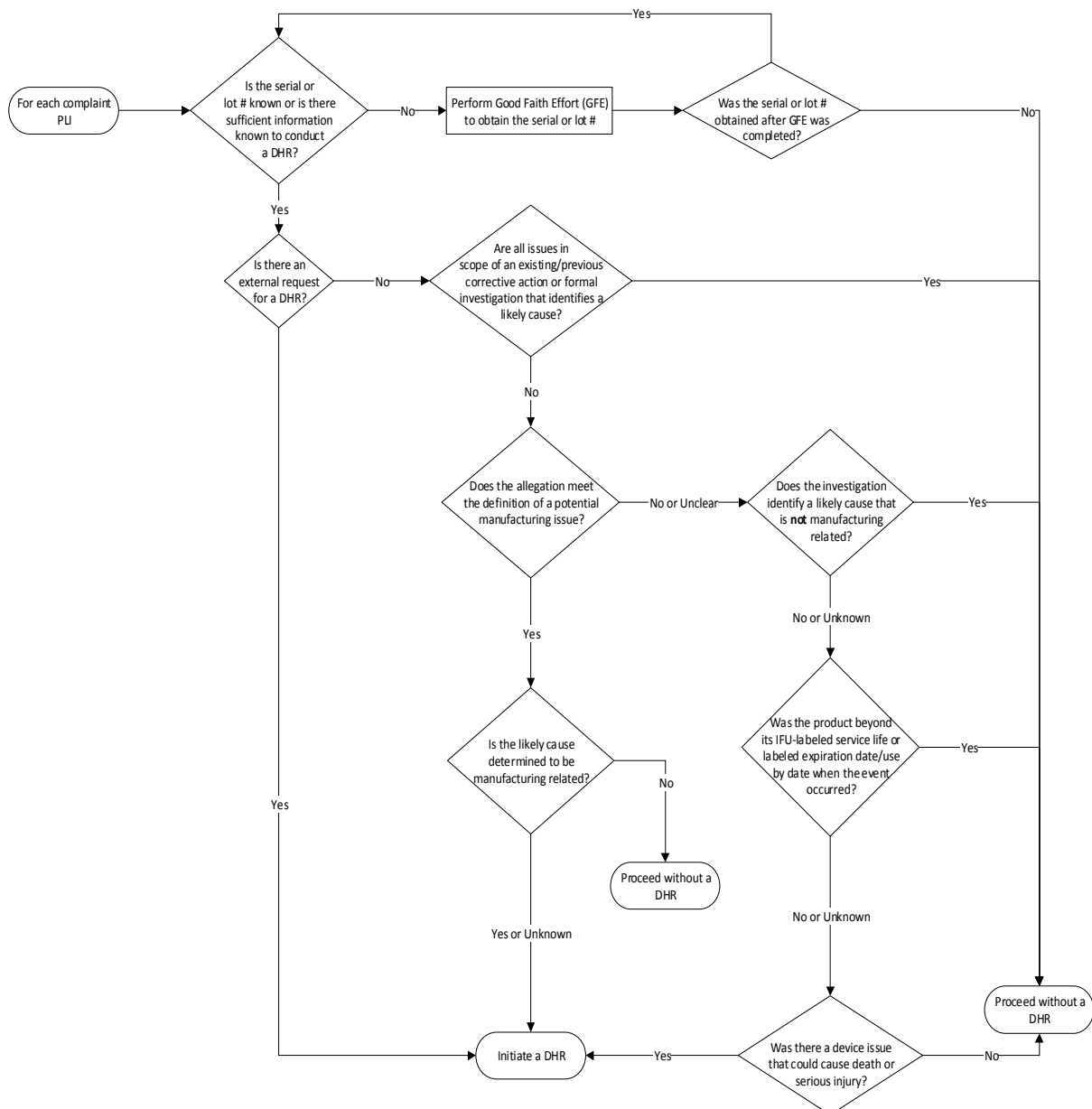
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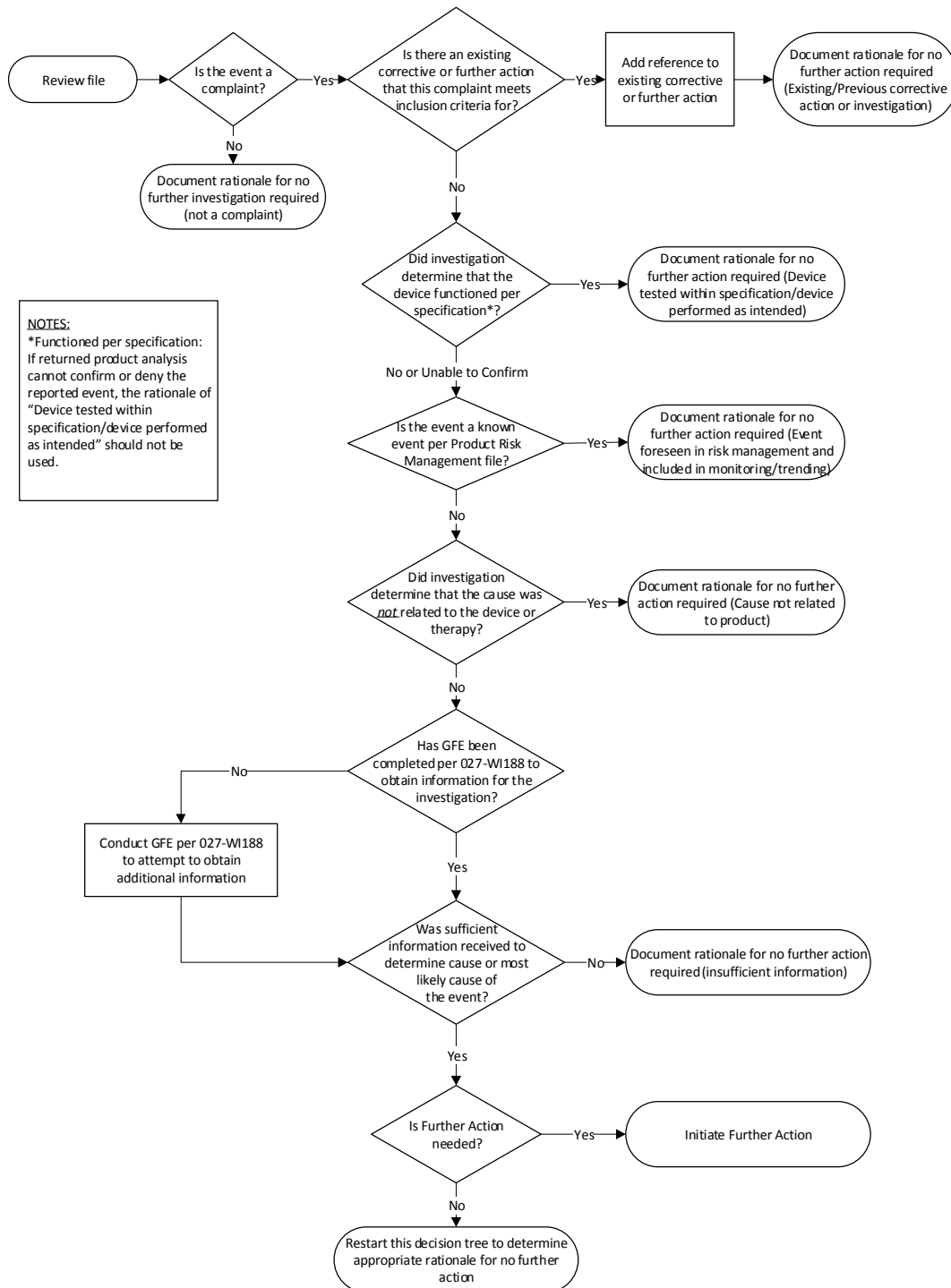
Task Type	Criteria to Initiate
	- See definition for “Labeled Adverse Event” in the Terms and Definitions section - For a FDCHU that does not have a Person Qualified to Make a Medical Judgement, this task may be used when there is an adverse event where the relationship to the device is unclear
Risk Documentation Assessment	Initiate a Risk Documentation Assessment if any of following criteria are met: - Event severity is higher than expected for a device or therapy issue (including events that meet criteria for an existing/previous investigation) - A Medical Safety Assessment concluded that a Risk Documentation Assessment may be needed

Appendix D – DHR Decision Tree

NOTE: The tree provides guidance for when a DHR is needed for both Medtronic and CM/OEM products. For Medtronic finished goods open a DHR task and for CM/OEM products open a CM/OEM task.



Appendix E – Rationale for No Further Action Flowchart



Appendix F – Investigation Completion Checklist

This checklist applies when an investigation is required and is meant to assist in a final review of the file before closure:

- ☐ Reviewed Event Information:
 - Event Narrative/Incoming Information
 - Analysis Results (including physical product, image reviews, service report, etc.)
- ☐ Technical Assessment Tasks, if applicable
 - Cybersecurity
 - DHR
 - Manufacturing
 - CM/OEM
 - Design
 - Medical Safety
 - Risk Documentation
- ☐ Cause of the Event
 - Cause, suspected cause and/or contributing factors
- ☐ Further Action Needed?
 - Yes - Follow escalation process
 - No - Document rationale for no further action
- ☐ Document Complaint Investigation Conclusion
 - Rationale for no DHR, if applicable
 - Conclusion of technical assessments, if applicable
 - Conclusion of any analysis performed, if applicable
 - Cause of the Event
 - Further action determination
- ☐ Review file for completeness of information as outlined in this document